

Views in SQL

A view is a virtual table whose contents are defined by a query. Like a table, a view consists of a set of named columns and rows of data. Unless indexed, a view does not exist as a stored set of data values in a database. The rows and columns of data come from tables referenced in the query defining the view and are produced dynamically when the view is referenced.

Views are virtual tables that hold data from one or more tables. It is stored in the database. A view does not contain any data itself, it is a set of queries that are applied to one or more tables that are stored within the database as an object. Views are used for security purposes in databases. Views restrict the user from viewing certain columns and rows. In other words, using a view we can apply the restriction on accessing specific rows and columns for a specific user. A view can be created using the tables of the same database or different databases. It is used to implement the security mechanism in the SQL Server.

DML Query In View: We can use SQL VIEW to insert, update and delete data in a single SQL table. We need to note the following things regarding this.

- We can use DML operation on a single table only
- VIEW should not contain Group By, Having, Distinct clauses
- We cannot use a subquery in a VIEW in SQL Server